

Cohen: 'Miners Need Confidence'

Win or lose, U.T.-El Paso's first baseball game in Western Athletic Conference play tomorrow at 2 p.m. against the University of New Mexico is a must.

Coach Andy Cohen plans to start Ray Greggerson (3-1) in the Miners' Southern Division opener at Dudley Field. U.T.-El Paso is 15-10 in regular season play while the Lobos support a 22-3 standard.

Radio Station KTEP-FM will broadcast all U.T.-El Paso baseball games, home and away. Bryan Houser and Jerry Batten are handling the mike work.

"IF WE ARE respectable in our first game," remarked Cohen, whose Miners were 1-17 last year in the WAC, "I think that the boys will get some confidence.

"They need to believe that they can play in the confer-

ence. If we can stay close, then I think that we will be all right."

Cohen emphasized that the Miners seemed anxious to start in the conference. U.T.-El Paso has had its tight moments already this year as the Miners have played in 12 one-run ball games. The Miners have an 8-4 mark in these close battles, two of which were won in 11 innings.

ONE OF U.T.-El Paso's big weaknesses this year has been in fielding. The Miners have committed 40 errors in the 27 games with half of the miscues being handled between third basemen Glen Villarreal and shortstop Herb von Hagen.

"They have made mostly mental mistakes," Cohen pointed out, "like not bearing down on their throws. But while they have made the mistakes, both seem to be settling down. I would have to say that their overall play has been good and I am expecting some good performances."

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